Day 24 - Great Esker, Reservoir, Trafalgar, Duff Pit

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 32 · Great Esker Side Trail

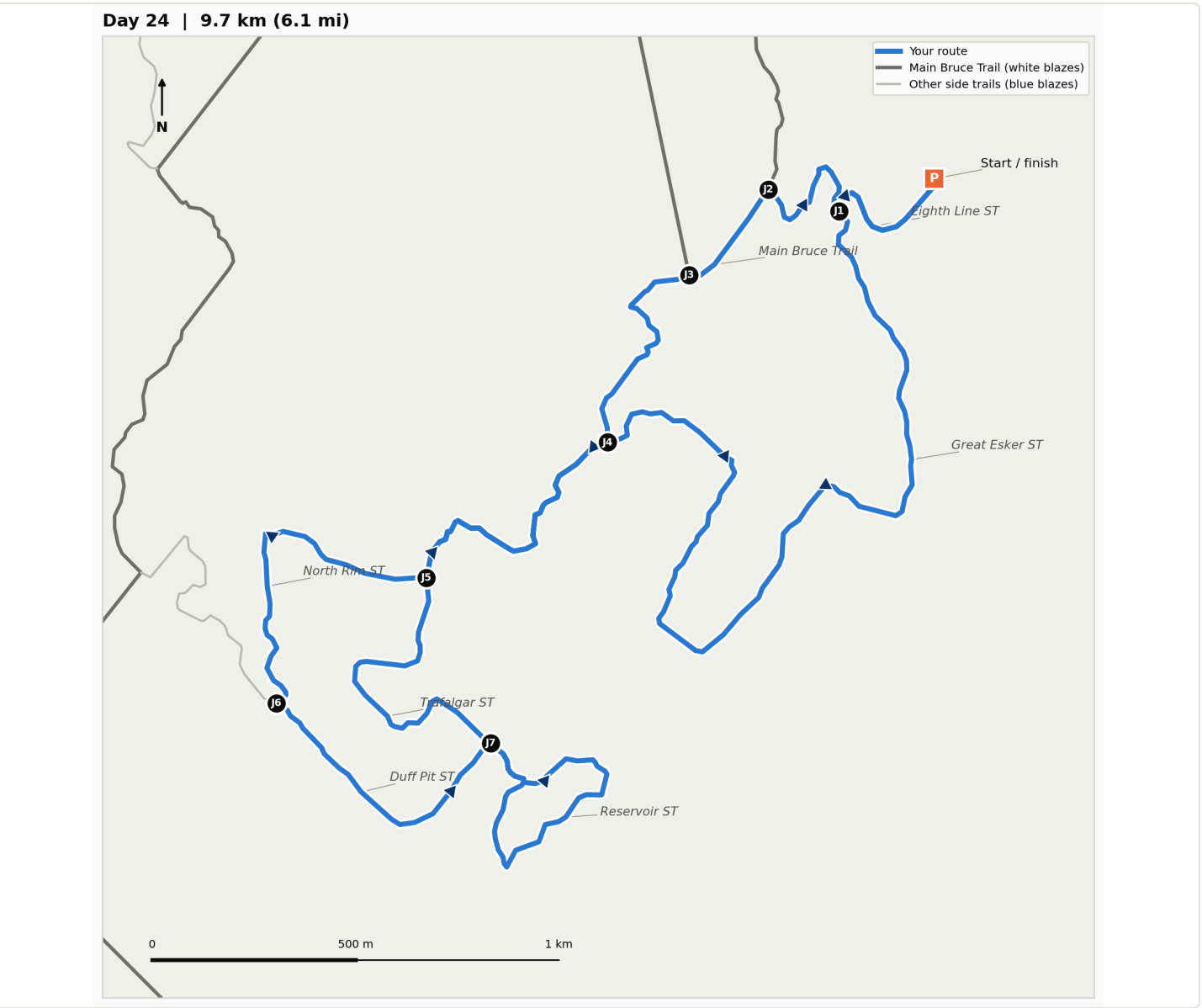
9.7 km / 6.1 mi	~2.7 h	5.2 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day24_hike032.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Great Esker Side Trail (2.6 km); Reservoir Side Trail (1.0 km); Trafalgar Side Trail (0.9 km); Duff Pit Side Trail (0.8 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Eighth Line across from the Eighth Line Side Trail. Parking in the Silver Creek area can fill on weekends from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m.; there are no washrooms.
- **Great Esker Side Trail:** Runs partly along the top of an esker, a rare glacial sand-and-gravel ridge, about 30 m above the land around it, with a moderate climb onto it. Look for old stone fences, granite boulders and a rusting 1940s car; butterflies abound along the trail.
- **Cautions:** Poison ivy grows along the trail edges; keep Zappy to the path. A hiking club describes the area as uneven, with roots, rocks and some mud.
- **Other side trails:** No descriptions were found for the Trafalgar, Duff Pit or Reservoir side trails. Follow the blue blazes and the guide's directions.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line. Head south on the blue-blazed Eighth Line Side Trail.
0.4	0.2	J1: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail goes off on your left.)
0.8	0.5	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.1	0.7	J3: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.7	1.0	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail goes off on your left.)
2.4	1.5	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed North Rim Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.3	2.1	J6: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Duff Pit Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Duff Pit Side Trail goes off on your right.)
4.1	2.5	J7: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Reservoir Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail goes off on your left.) This is a short excursion (about 1160 m in all): walk the whole Reservoir Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
5.2	3.2	J7: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail, heading north-west. (the Duff Pit Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
6.1	3.8	J5: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Trafalgar Side Trail, heading north. (the North Rim Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
6.8	4.2	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading east. (the Great Esker Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.4	5.8	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Eighth Line Side Trail, heading north. (the Great Esker Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
9.7	6.1	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Hiking the GTA, Ontario Nature Trails, the Guelph Hiking Trail Club and Credit Valley Conservation.